# MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Engineering
Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | GitLab: gitlab.com/mkb-example

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with experience spanning quality engineering, CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and has delivered faster builds, ephemeral Kubernetes test environments and test observability for multiple product teams. Also builds and monitors a personal k3s homelab, with hands-on Terraform experience provisioning a small Hetzner VPS.

## CORE SKILLS

CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm
Containers and orchestration: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to shared cluster), k3s (personal homelab)
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS); Ansible (basic)
Cloud: AWS (learning: EC2 and S3 basics)
Monitoring and data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems and tools: Linux, Git, Argo CD, Traefik, cert-manager

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024-2025**

- Run a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, deploying applications from a Git repository with Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

**QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw | 2021-Present**

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end tests, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Grafana dashboards for flaky tests using CI results, PostgreSQL and the GitLab API.
- Wrote Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and an internal CI guide used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

**QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2019-2021**

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.

- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

**Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019**

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

**Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023-2024**

- Deployed a short-lived application and PostgreSQL environment with seeded data for each merge request, using GitLab CI and Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Automatically removed environments after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; enabled QA and product reviews before merge and end-to-end testing against each environment.

**CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022**

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into their own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

**Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023**

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the leading causes.

## EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

## CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam booked for January 2027; not yet certified

## LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)